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Expanded Deck of the Week #41: Vileplume / Slowking

(You know the drill, I post about Expanded)

For my last thread before Journey Together (which has some Expanded-playable cards), I'm going to cover another Vileplume Control deck, as it's been a while.

Thread 

(1/15)



A quick reminder of how the engine works: play Guzma & Hala on turn 1 (there are eight outs to it, counting Tag Call and Call Bell). Search for Artazon, TM: Evolution, and either Capture or Jet Energy depending on whether you have Bunnelby active or not.

(2/15)

TRAINER

Supporter

Guzma & Hala

TAG TEAM



Search your deck for a Stadium card, reveal it, and put it into your hand. Then, shuffle your deck.

When you play this card, you may discard 2 other cards from your hand. If you do, you may also search for a Pokémon Tool card and a Special Energy card in this way.

You may play only 1 Supporter card during your turn (before your attack).

Illus. Ken Sugimori

193/236 ♦

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TRAINER

Item

Tag Call



Search your deck for up to 2 **TAG TEAM** cards, reveal them, and put them into your hand. Then, shuffle your deck.

You may play as many Item cards as you like during your turn (before your attack).

Illus. Toyste Beach

206/236 ◆

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ENERGY



Capture Energy

Special Energy



As long as this card is attached to a Pokémon, it provides
★ Energy.

When you attach this card from your hand to a Pokémon,
search your deck for a Basic Pokémon and put it onto
your Bench. Then, shuffle your deck.

⚡ 171/192 ♦

BASIC

Bunnelby

HP 60



Ω Barrage

This Pokémon may attack twice a turn. (If the first attack Knocks Out your opponent's Active Pokémon, you may attack again after your opponent chooses a new Active Pokémon.)



Burrow

Discard the top card of your opponent's deck.



Rototiller

Shuffle a card from your discard pile into your deck.

weakness



x2

resistance

retreat



It has ears like shovels. Digging holes strengthens its ears so much that they can sever thick roots effortlessly.



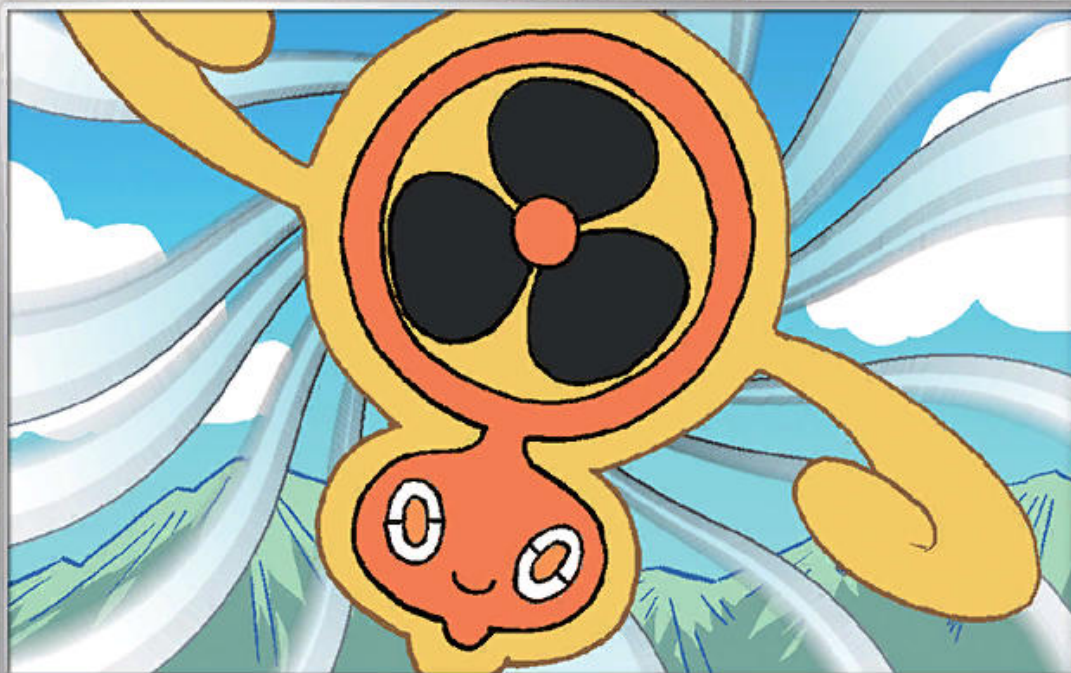
The goal is to get Bunnelby Active and Oddish + Pidgey on the Bench. For example, if you open Oddish, you can do it by getting with one Guzma & Hala by getting Fan Rotom with Artazon, Fan Call for Bunnelby and Pidgey (and Slakoth), Jet Energy on Bunnelby.

(3/15)

BASIC

Fan Rotom

HP 70 ★



NO. 0479 Plasma Pokémon HT: 1' WT: 0.7 lbs.

Ability**Fan Call**

Once during your first turn, you may search your deck for up to 3 ★ Pokémon with 100 HP or less, reveal them, and put them into your hand. Then, shuffle your deck. You can't use more than 1 Fan Call Ability during your turn.

**Assault Landing**

70

If there is no Stadium in play, this attack does nothing.

weakness ⚡ × 2

resistance 🖐️ -30

retreat ★

Illus. Toshinao Aoki



SCREEN

118/142 ●

There are several appliances that Rotom can inspire, but the first one to be developed was the electric fan.

(Obviously, Buddy-Buddy Poffin makes it even easier, as does opening Bunnelby.)
Then attach TM: Evolution to Bunnelby, use Evolution on Pidgey and Oddish, and use it again, thanks to Bunnelby's Omega Barrage, on Pidgeotto and Gloom.
You now have Vileplume and Pidgeot ex in play.

STAGE 2

Vileplume

HP 130



Evolves from Gloom



NO. 045 Flower Pokémon HT: 3'11" WT: 41.0 lbs.

Ability

Irritating Pollen

Each player can't play any Item cards from his or her hand.



Solar Beam

70

weakness



x2

resistance

retreat



*It has the world's largest petals.
With every step, the petals shake
out heavy clouds of toxic pollen.*

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Illus. Midori Harada

3/98 ★



STAGE 2

Pidgeot **EX**

HP 280 ★

Evolves from Pidgeotto

**Ability****Quick Search**

Once during your turn, you may search your deck for a card and put it into your hand. Then, shuffle your deck. You can't use more than 1 Quick Search Ability each turn.

**Blustery Wind****120**

You may discard a Stadium in play.

weakness ⚡ × 2

resistance 🖐️ -30

retreat

Illus. takuyoa



OBF EN

164/197 ★★

Pokémon EX ruleWhen your Pokémon **EX**

is Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.

At this point the lock is set and the goal of the deck is to maintain it throughout the game, while dealing with the opponent's threats.

The Ace Spec choice, Grand Tree, makes it easier to set up stage 2 Pokémon throughout the game if needed.

(5/15)

Stadium

TRAINER

Grand Tree



Once during each player's turn, that player may search their deck for a Stage 1 Pokémon that evolves from 1 of their Basic Pokémon and put it onto that Pokémon to evolve it. If that Pokémon was evolved in this way, that player may search their deck for a Stage 2 Pokémon that evolves from that Pokémon and put it onto that Pokémon to evolve it. Then, that player shuffles their deck. *(Players can't evolve a Basic Pokémon during their first turn or a Basic Pokémon that was put into play this turn.)*

You can't have more than
1 ACE SPEC card in your deck.

Illus. AYUMI ODASHIMA



SCR EN

136/142 ★

You may play only 1 Stadium card during your turn. Put it next to the Active Spot, and discard it if another Stadium comes into play. A Stadium with the same name can't be played.

While a pure Control version of this deck exists (and won CL Aichi last year), variants which use an attacker to deal with opposing threats are more popular. Dragapult ex is a common choice for this role, but this version uses Slaking ex instead for its higher damage output.

STAGE 2

Slaking^{ex}

HP 340 ★

Evolves from Vigoroth

**Ability****Born to Slack**

If your opponent has no Pokémon **ex** or Pokémon **V** in play, this Pokémon can't attack.

**Great Swing****280**

Discard an Energy from this Pokémon.

weakness × 2

resistance

retreat



Illus. PLANETA Igarashi



SSP EN

147/191 ★★

Pokémon EX ruleWhen your Pokémon **ex**

is Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.

Slaking ex can oneshot many key Pokémon (Regidrago VSTAR, Lugia VSTAR, any relevant Tag Team...) while also having higher HP than Dragapult ex (340 vs 320 doesn't matter often, but it means it tanks something like Dragon Ascent + Muscle Band from Regidrago VSTAR).

(7/15)

VSTAR**Regidrago** **VSTAR**HP **280**

Evolves from Regidrago V

**Apex Dragon**

Choose an attack from a Pokémon in your discard pile and use it as this attack.

VSTAR Power**Ability****Legacy Star**

During your turn, you may discard the top 7 cards of your deck. Then, put up to 2 cards from your discard pile into your hand. (You can't use more than 1 **VSTAR** Power in a game.)

weakness

resistance

retreat



Illus. PLANETA Yamashita

**F**

136/195 ★

VSTAR ruleWhen your Pokémon **VSTAR**

is Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.

MEGA



M Rayquaza EX

HP 230



Evolves from Rayquaza-EX

Δ Wild

Any damage done to this Pokémon by attacks from your opponent's ⚡, ⚡, ⚡, or ⚡ Pokémon is reduced by 20 (after applying Weakness and Resistance).



Mega Evolution rule

When 1 of your Pokémon becomes a Mega Evolution Pokémon, your turn ends.



Dragon Ascent

300

Discard 2 Energy attached to this Pokémon.

Weakness



×2

Resistance

Retreat



Pokémon-EX rule

When a Pokémon-EX has been Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.



TRAINER

ITEM

Muscle Band



Pokémon Tool

Attach a Pokémon Tool to 1 of your Pokémon that doesn't already have a Pokémon Tool attached to it.

The attacks of the Pokémon this card is attached to do 20 more damage to your opponent's Active Pokémon (*before applying Weakness and Resistance*).

You may play as many Item cards as you like during your turn (*before your attack*).



Its Colorless typing is also situationally useful, as it means that Fan Rotom can grab Slakoth in addition to Bunnelby and Pidgey.

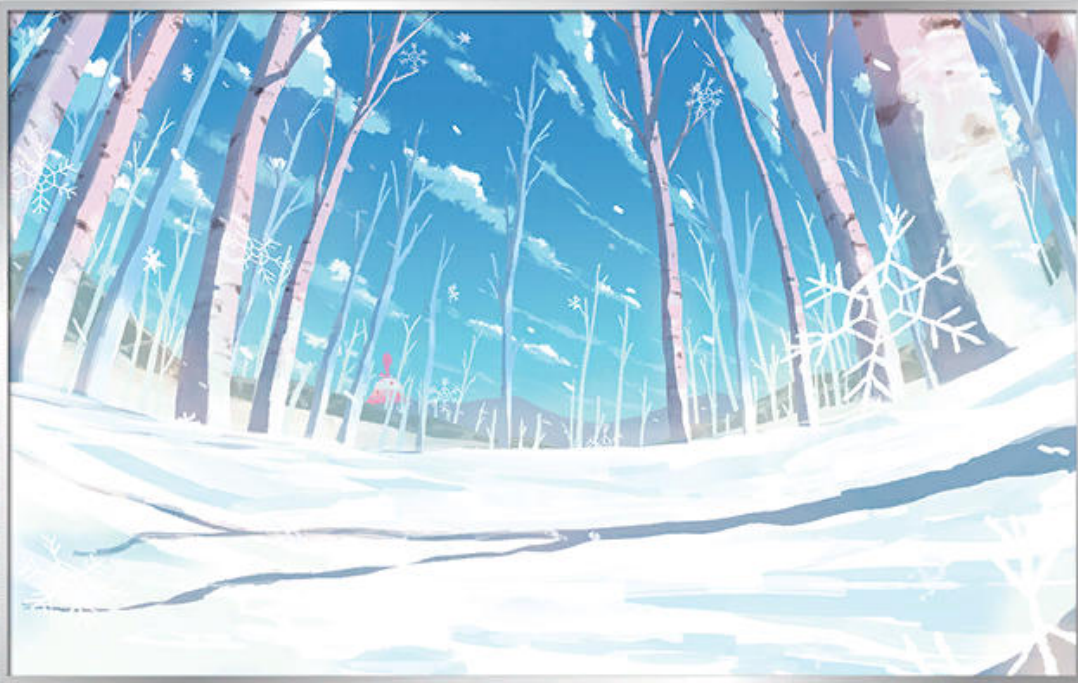
Its Ability is a downside, but most decks play ex or V Pokémon. And even if they don't, the Ability can be negated with Path to the Peak.

(8/15)

TRAINER

Stadium

Path to the Peak



Pokémon with a Rule Box in play (both yours and your opponent's) have no Abilities. (Pokémon **V**, Pokémon **-GX**, etc. have Rule Boxes.)

Illus. Oswaldo KATO

♣ **E** 148/198 ♦

This Stadium stays in play when you play it. Discard it if another Stadium comes into play. If a Stadium with the same name is in play, you can't play this card.

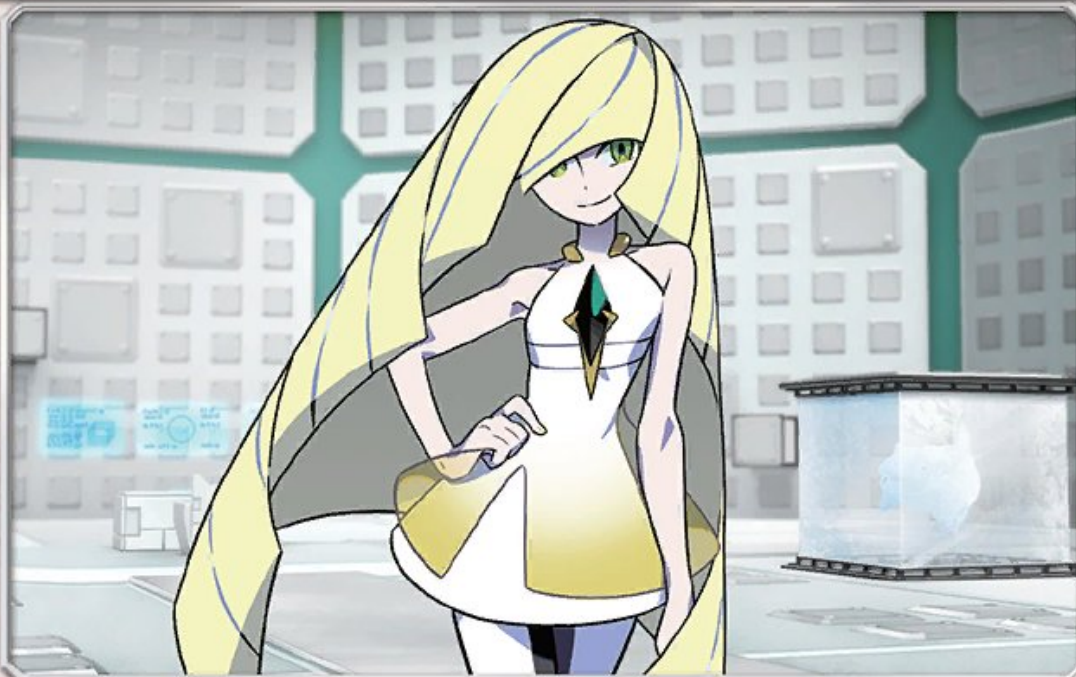
Note the inclusion of Lusamine to recover this Stadium (and Grand Tree and Supporters) if needed. Bunnelby can also bring other cards (including Lusamine) in the deck with Rototiller, to ensure that the deck never runs out of resources.

(9/15)

TRAINER

Supporter

Lusamine



Put 2 in any combination of Supporter and Stadium cards from your discard pile into your hand.

You may play only 1 Supporter card during your turn (before your attack).

Illus. take

96/111 ◆

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And of course, Bunnelby itself can be recovered with Karen if needed. Karen is also a great card against Regidrago and Lugia when combined with Item lock, preventing Battle Compressor.

(By the way, Karen has recently been included in more decks alongside Budew.)

(10/15)

TRAINER

SUPPORTER

Karen



Each player shuffles all Pokémon in his or her discard pile into his or her deck.

You may play only 1 Supporter card during your turn (before your attack).



TRAINER

ITEM

Battle Compressor Team Flare Gear



Search your deck for up to 3 cards and discard them. Shuffle your deck afterward.

You may play as many Item cards as you like during your turn (before your attack).



While Slaking ex will usually use Double Colorless Energy to attack, it can also use a combination of Jet and Capture if needed, an advantage it has over Dragapult.

(11/15)

ENERGY



Double Colorless Energy

Special Energy



Double Colorless Energy provides ★★ Energy.



69/73 ◆

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The deck also runs Triple Acceleration Energy, which can help against some cards that increase Energy cost, like Wondrous Labyrinth Prism Star or Goomy. Since the Energy will be discarded by Great Swing anyway, its downside doesn't matter.

(12/15)

ENERGY



Triple Acceleration Energy *Special Energy*



This card can only be attached to Evolution Pokémon. If this card is attached to 1 of your Pokémon, discard it at the end of the turn.

This card provides ★★ ★ Energy only while it is attached to an Evolution Pokémon.

If this card is attached to anything other than an Evolution Pokémon, discard this card.

TRAINER

Stadium

Wondrous Labyrinth



◇ (Prism Star) Rule

You can't have more than 1 ◇ card with the same name in your deck. If a ◇ card would go to the discard pile, put it in the Lost Zone instead.

The attacks of non-♣ Pokémon (*both yours and your opponent's*) cost ★ more.

Whenever any player plays an Item or Supporter card from their hand, prevent all effects of that card done to this Stadium card.

Illus. 5ban Graphics

158/181 ★

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This card stays in play when you play it. Discard this card if another Stadium card comes into play. If another card with the same name is in play, you can't play this card.

BASIC

Goomy

HP 40



NO. 704 Soft Tissue Pokémon HT: 1'00" WT: 6.2 lbs.

Ability

Sticky Membrane

As long as this Pokémon is your Active Pokémon, your opponent's Pokémon's attacks cost ★ more.



Ram

10

weakness  × 2

resistance

retreat 

Illus. Midori Harada



91/131 ●

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Its source of protection is its slimy, germ-laden mucous membrane. Anyone who touches it needs some thorough hand-washing.

Finally, I'll point out that the deck runs Pokémon Ranger, unlike the Vileplume / Dragapult list I showcased some time ago. This helps with Shadow Rider which has increased in play (and will continue to do so thanks to Lillie's Clefairy ex), as Shadow Mist can be a big issue.

TRAINER

SUPPORTER

Pokémon Ranger



Remove all effects of attacks on each player and his or her Pokémon.

You may play only 1 Supporter card during your turn (before your attack).



BASIC

Shadow Rider **Calyrex** **V**

HP **210** 



Shadow Mist

10

During your opponent's next turn, they can't play any Special Energy or Stadium cards from their hand.



Astral Barrage

Choose 2 of your opponent's Pokémon and put 5 damage counters on each of them.

weakness  × 2

resistance  -30

retreat  

Illus. D.A.G Inc.



E 074/198 ★

V rule

When your Pokémon **V** is Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.

If you want to see the deck in action, you can check out @TDS 's recent video: [youtube.co
/watch?v=hl-liM...](https://youtube.com/watch?v=hl-liM...)

You can also check out my older threads on Vileplume/Dragapult and Vileplume Control for more info on these variants!

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x.com/lubyllule/stat...

Thanks for reading!

Also, I often meet people at regionals who tell me they love these threads, and it means a lot to me.

I'm happy to try to keep this format alive, and I have some ideas that I hope will make it easier for newcomers to get into. Announcement soon!

(15/15)

To see the other Expanded threads:

linktr.ee/lubyllule

Source: <https://x.com/lubyllule/status/1904303865899733083>

Thread: <https://twitter-thread.com/t/1904303865899733083>